

GST Provider - Full Recommendation Report

For the Credit Signal Report: look up a buyer's GSTIN -> filing history, compliance & turnover. Star rating = fit for this project (5 = most recommended).

1. Pros, Cons & Rating

Provider	Pros	Cons	Rating & Verdict
Karza (Perfios)	Built for lending/underwriting; deep filing history, compliance & turnover signals; trusted by NBFCs	Enterprise sales motion; pricing opaque; can be pricier	★★★★★ 5.0 / 5 MOST RECOMMENDED - returns exactly the credit signals our risk model needs.
Clear (ClearTax)	A real GSP; mature GST APIs; good docs; strong GST domain depth	More filing/compliance-oriented than credit-signal-oriented	★★★★☆ 4.0 / 5 Strong alternative / backup provider.
Perfios	Enterprise-grade, 99.9% uptime SLA; large client base; owns Karza stack	Geared to bigger clients; pricing on request	★★★★☆ 4.0 / 5 Good - same group as Karza; use its credit stack.
Surepass	Cheap, fast plug-and-play; batch processing; 3000+ clients	Thin on filing-history / compliance depth	★★★☆☆ 3.5 / 5 Best for a cheap pilot; upgrade later for depth.
Signzy	Customisable end-to-end KYB onboarding flows	Heavier than plug-and-play; overkill for simple GSTIN lookups	★★★☆☆ 3.0 / 5 Only if we want full KYB orchestration.
Others (HyperVerge, Cashfree, Attestr, IDfy, BeFiSc)	Easy, cheap, instant integration	Mostly identity verification; little filing-history depth	★★★☆☆ 2.5 / 5 Not recommended - too shallow for credit scoring.
Govt GST Portal (GSTN, direct)	Authoritative first-party data; no reseller markup	Needs GSP licence: Rs 2-5 cr capital + GSTN contract; built for filing; months of effort	★☆☆☆☆ 1.0 / 5 NOT recommended for MVP - huge barrier, kills launch speed.



2. BEST & PREFERRED: Karza (now part of Perfios)

Karza (Perfios) is the best and preferred choice because its GST stack is purpose-built for lending and underwriting. Unlike commodity verifiers that only confirm a GSTIN is valid, Karza returns the exact signals our risk model scores on: filing history (GSTR-1 / GSTR-3B), compliance gaps, cancellation/suspension status and derived turnover. It is trusted by NBFCs, handles the GSTN tunnel for us (no GSP licence or government contract), and gives the deepest credit-relevant data of any option - earning the full 5/5 fit rating.

Preferred rollout: pilot on Surepass (cheap, fast) to launch quickly, then switch to Karza (Perfios) via a swappable GstProvider interface. Keep Clear (ClearTax) as the backup provider.

3. Why not the others

Clear (ClearTax)	More built for filing/compliance than credit signals - keep only as a backup.
Perfios (plain verification)	Use the Karza credit stack inside Perfios, not just plain verification.
Surepass	Thin on filing-history/compliance depth - okay for a cheap pilot, not the real score.
Signzy	A heavy end-to-end KYB flow - overkill for simple GSTIN credit lookups.
Others (HyperVerge, Cashfree, Attestr, IDfy, BeFiSc)	Only confirm a GSTIN is valid - too shallow for credit scoring.
Govt GST Portal (direct)	Needs a GSP licence (Rs 2-5 cr capital + GSTN contract) - kills launch speed.

4. Testing without paying

Layer 1 - Build a MockGstProvider returning fake but realistic data: test the whole scoring + report flow offline with no API keys, no rate limits, no payment. Layer 2 - free sandboxes below.

Provider	Free testing	Notes for us
Perfios	10,000+ free sandbox credits	BEST - same stack as Karza; test real signals free
Sandbox.co.in (Quicko)	Free to start; good docs + test cases	Search GSTIN + return-status (compliance) APIs
AppyFlow	50 free requests	Basic verification only - too shallow for scoring
GSTINCheck	20 free requests (email)	Quick smoke test only
Govt GST Developer Portal	Sandbox + sample test keys	Production GSP-gated; sandbox fine for trials

Bottom line: Develop against MockGstProvider (free, offline) -> validate on Perfios sandbox (10k free credits) -> go live on Karza (Perfios). One swappable

GstProvider interface; cache + cost-log every call. Karza is the only option giving deep, credit-relevant GST data without a GSP licence.